

AUTOMATION · May 2026 · 5 min read

Transforming Meeting Records into Organizational Knowledge at Zero Additional Cost

Every transcript tool hits a paywall. We built a pipeline using Fathom, Zapier, Google Drive, and Claude AI, delivering full transcripts and conversational meeting intelligence, completely no cost.

\$0

Monthly transcript tool cost

 ∞

Meetings supported

4

Steps to set up

0

Manual site visits

THE PROBLEM

Transcripts are expensive or limited

Meeting transcripts have become essential for distributed teams. But the moment you start scaling, the free tiers of every major tool disappear behind a paywall. Is there a way to get full, unlimited transcripts without yet another subscription?

The real friction points

- Free tools cap you at 300-800 min/month. One heavy week and you are locked out.
- Paid tools charge per user, per seat, or per minute. Costs compound fast.
- Transcripts sit siloed in third-party repository with no easy way to query them.
- No tool lets you have a conversation with your meeting data out of the box.

EXPLORATION

What we tried first

We evaluated the major transcript tools: what is genuinely free, and what you actually got before hitting a wall.

Free tools Limited		Paid tools Expensive	
• Otter.ai	800 min/month cap	• Notion AI	Extra add-on cost
• Fireflies	800 min/month free tier	• Zoom AI Companion	Paid plan required
• Fathom	Free, data stays on their site	• Teams Premium	Per-user licensing
• Rev	Per-minute charges after trial	• All tools	Charge the moment you scale up

Fathom stood out as genuinely free with no minute limits. The only catch: your data lives on Fathom's site and you must visit manually. That gave us the idea for the pipeline.

THE SOLUTION

A 4 step automation pipeline

We connected Fathom, Google Meet, Zapier, Google Drive, and Claude AI into a seamless pipeline.

1 STEP	Integrate Fathom with Google Meet Connect Google Meet to Fathom. Every meeting is recorded and transcribed automatically, free, with no minute cap.	 + 
2 STEP	Automate: Fathom recording to Google Drive A Zap fires after each meeting, saving the transcript directly to a designated Google Drive folder. <i>Note: Only a Fathom link saves to Drive, not the transcript text.</i>	 + 
3 STEP	Enable Fathom connector inside Claude Claude's native Fathom connector reads transcript content directly from the API, bypassing the link-only limitation.	 + 
4 STEP	Interact with meeting data, unlimited and free Ask Claude anything about any meeting. Summarize, extract action items, compare calls conversationally, free.	 + 

Calendar tip: After Claude reads your transcript, simply say: "Schedule a follow-up with the same attendees for next week." Claude checks availability, creates the event, and sends invites via your connected Google Calendar automatically. ( + )

THE KEY INSIGHT

Claude bridges the data gap

Fathom does the hard work of transcribing. But the intelligence, the ability to search, query, and extract meaning from meetings, needs one more layer.

Without Claude	With Claude + Fathom connector
 Only a Fathom link saved to Drive, not the content	 Claude fetches full transcript on demand
 Manual Fathom visit required every time	 Ask anything in plain language, no site visit
 No cross-meeting search or querying	 Summarise, extract action items, search meetings
 Data locked in a third-party UI	 Unlimited. Claude has no meeting cap

WHAT WE LEARNED

Key takeaways

Lessons from building this pipeline

- 1 Free tools can deliver enterprise-level results when the data flow is designed correctly. The challenge is rarely tool quality; it's connecting the right systems and ensuring seamless access to information.
- 2 Automation is the foundation of scalability. Zapier acts as the orchestration layer, eliminating manual work and creating an invisible workflow that continuously captures, processes, and organizes meeting knowledge.
- 3 The true value lies beyond transcription. By combining Claude with MCP connectors such as Fathom, meeting data becomes conversationally accessible, turning AI into an active knowledge retrieval system that scales from **10 to 1,000+ meetings without increasing costs.**

A Note from Our Team: We've made sure the setup is as simple as possible and the best part. You only do it once. After that, everything runs like clockwork.

If you require assistance. We're always here, happy to walk you through every step.

Contact us: info_arnaintelligence@alis-global.com

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